

Sunday, 23 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 23° 15°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 22° 12°	MANCHESTER Overcast 21° 11°	GLASGOW Overcast 18° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A West Sussex town is coming together to mourn a family who tragically died after getting into difficulty in the sea off Shoreham.

A vigil was held for the family who lost their lives in the water. The community has been deeply affected by the heartbreaking incident.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 2

Seven people, including two police officers, have been killed in a horrific car crash on the A66 near Middlesbrough.

The incident occurred when a car was travelling the wrong way down the dual carriageway and collided with a police vehicle. Investigations are now underway.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 3

Prince Harry and six other high-profile individuals are facing a legal bill of up to £34.5 million after losing a privacy case.

The group, including Sir Elton John and Liz Hurley, must pay the Daily Mail publisher an initial £9.54 million within the next seven days. It follows a significant legal battle.

LEGAL · UK
- 4

The UK could be in for a stormy autumn and a cold winter, with this year's El Niño expected to be the strongest in living memory.

Forecasters are warning of a range of potential impacts across the country. It could lead to significant weather changes in the coming months.

WEATHER · UK
- 5

Ofcom is investigating Sky News over claims of harassment made by Reform UK leader Nigel Farage.

Mr Farage has accused the broadcaster of sending reporters to a house where his adult daughter lives. The media regulator will now look into the allegations.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Meghan, the Duchess of Sussex, is reportedly in talks for a role in the Netflix series 'The Gentlemen'.**
 This would mark her first major acting role since marrying Prince Harry. It's an exciting prospect for fans of the show and the Duchess.
| ON AIR – Would you like to see Meghan back on screen? What kind of character do you think she'd play?
 TV · COMING UP
- 2 Former wrestler Dave Bautista has been confirmed as the new star of the 'God of War' series.**
 He will be taking over the role of Kratos from Ryan Hurst in the upcoming adaptation of the popular PlayStation game. Fans are eager to see his portrayal.
| ON AIR – Are you a fan of the 'God of War' games? Do you think Dave Bautista is a good choice for Kratos?
 TV · COMING UP
- 3 Music lovers are being urged to plan ahead for the upcoming Reading Festival, which kicks off next Thursday.**
 The popular music festival runs from Thursday, August 27th, until Sunday, August 30th. Expect traffic and busy transport routes around the area.
| ON AIR – Are you heading to Reading Festival this year? Who are you most excited to see?
 MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 4 Beninese musical icon Angélique Kidjo has made Hollywood Walk of Fame history, dedicating her star to Africa.**
 She spoke about the importance of Africa and Africans in music as she received the prestigious honour. It's a moment of pride for the continent.
| ON AIR – What's your favourite Angélique Kidjo song? She's such an incredible talent!
 AWARDS · NOW
- 5 Priyanka Chopra Jonas is executive producing a new film about love and caste inequality.**
 The movie, 'The Cycle of Love', is based on the true story of an Indian artist who cycled from India to Europe to reunite with his wife. It promises to be a powerful story.
| ON AIR – Have you heard of the true story behind 'The Cycle of Love'? What a romantic and inspiring journey!
 FILM · COMING UP

On the schedule

1

Tennis legends Serena Williams and Carlos Alcaraz are set to team up for the mixed doubles at the US Open.

This exciting pairing will see two of the biggest names in tennis join forces at Flushing Meadows. It's sure to draw a huge crowd.

ON AIR – What a dream team! Do you think Serena and Alcaraz could go all the way in the mixed doubles?

TENNIS · THIS WEEK

2

Manchester United's new Premier League season got off to a disappointing start with a 2-0 defeat to newly promoted Hull City.

Manager Michael Carrick admitted his side 'didn't click' in their opening game. It's a tough start for the Red Devils.

ON AIR – Man Utd fans, what did you make of that opening performance? Is it too early to panic?

FOOTBALL · UK

3

Joe Root has made a triumphant return as England cricket captain, leading his team to an emphatic innings victory against Pakistan.

Root praised his side as 'outstanding' after their dominant performance in the opening Test at Headingley. It's a superb start to his second spell at the helm.

ON AIR – What a way to start his second captaincy! Are you feeling optimistic about England's chances this series?

CRICKET · UK

4

Arsenal manager Mikel Arteta is 'delighted' with his side's convincing 3-0 win over Coventry City in their Premier League opener.

The Gunners started their campaign in style, securing a comfortable victory. It's a strong statement from the defending champions.

ON AIR – Arsenal fans, how are you feeling after that opening win? Is this a sign of things to come?

FOOTBALL · UK

5

Rory McIlroy has fallen five shots off the pace after a challenging second round at the BMW Championship in St Louis.

The overnight joint leader now trails Wyndham Clark. He'll be hoping to bounce back in the third round.

ON AIR – Can Rory pull it back over the weekend? Or is the gap too big to close?

GOLF · NOW

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals that the soothing sound of rain can genuinely improve our sleep quality.**
Researchers found that the consistent, non-threatening rhythm of rainfall helps mask other noises, creating a more peaceful environment for slumber. Perhaps it's time to invest in a rain sound machine!
- 2 The simple act of 'doodling' during meetings or phone calls has been shown to boost memory and concentration.**
Far from being a sign of inattention, experts say that light sketching can help the brain stay engaged and retain information more effectively. So, next time you're in a lengthy chat, grab a pen and paper!
- 3 The surprising popularity of 'board game cafes' is growing across the UK, offering a nostalgic and social alternative to screens.**
These welcoming spots provide a relaxed setting for friends and families to connect over classic and modern board games, often with a cuppa and a slice of cake. It's proper good, old-fashioned fun!
- 4 Research suggests that 'taking a short, brisk walk' can be just as effective as a coffee for an afternoon energy boost.**
Even ten to fifteen minutes of movement can increase blood flow and oxygen to the brain, helping to shake off that post-lunch slump without the caffeine jitters. Perfect for a quick break from your desk.
- 5 The joyful trend of 'community book swaps' is flourishing, encouraging neighbours to share their favourite reads.**
From dedicated little street libraries to informal meet-ups, it's a lovely way to discover new authors and chat about books without spending a penny. A real boost for local connections!
- 6 Scientists have found that 'listening to upbeat music' can significantly improve our mood and even reduce feelings of anxiety.**
Putting on your favourite happy tunes can stimulate the release of feel-good chemicals in the brain, making it a great tool for a quick pick-me-up. Time for a little boogie!
- 7 The humble 'garden shed' is undergoing a renaissance, transforming into everything from home offices to creative studios.**
No longer just for tools, these versatile outbuildings are being reimagined as peaceful retreats, offering a quiet space away from the main house. Who knew a shed could be so chic?

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a meal is ready, even if we know it's probably not the most accurate method?

ANSWER: POKING IT WITH A FORK OR SPOON, PRETENDING TO 'TEST' IT!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to watch their favourite TV show or film. What is it?

ANSWER: ARRANGING ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA JUST SO!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you stumble upon a 'hidden gem' in your local area – a lovely little shop, a cafe, or a beautiful park that you wish more people knew about?

What's your local area's best kept secret, and why do you love it so much? Give us a call and share your hidden treasures!

- We all have those 'little everyday moments' that just make us smile, don't we? It could be something simple like hearing a certain bird song or seeing a friendly dog on a walk.

What's a small, simple thing that happened recently that just brought a bit of unexpected joy to your day? We'd love to hear your happy little moments!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that oak trees can live for over 1,000 years, making them one of the longest-living tree species in the UK?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights, or Aurora Borealis, can sometimes be seen in parts of the UK, but only ever during a full moon.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The world's quietest room is located at Microsoft's headquarters in Washington state, where the background noise is so low it's measured in negative decibels.
- Butterflies are insects, and like all insects, they have six legs.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible even from outer space.
- Did you know that a 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time? It's defined as the time it takes for light to travel one centimetre in a vacuum, which is about 33.3 picoseconds.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to the expansion of the iron caused by heat.
- Chameleons change their skin colour not just to blend in, but also in response to their mood, temperature, and communication with other chameleons.

On this day

Day 235 of the year, 130 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Kursk Day (Russia); Christian feast day: Ascelina; Christian feast day: Asterius, Claudius, and Neon; Christian feast day: Éogan of Ardstraw. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Lianne La Havas, British singer, songwriter, and multi-instrumentalist
- 1974 — Ray Park, Scottish actor and stuntman
- 1981 — Jaime Lee Kirchner, American actress
- 1959 — Edwyn Collins, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1947 — David Robb, Scottish actor
- 1928 — Marian Seldes, American actress (died 2014)
- 1947 — Linda Thompson, English folk-rock singer-songwriter
- 1986 — Ayron Jones, American musician

THE DAY TODAY

- 1966 — Lunar Orbiter 1 takes the first photograph of Earth from orbit around the Moon.
- 2007 — The skeletal remains of Russia's last royal family members Alexei Nikolaevich, Tsarevich of Russia, and his sister Grand Duchess Anastasia are discovered near Yekaterinburg, Russia.
- 2012 — A hot-air balloon crashes near the Slovenian capital of Ljubljana, killing six people and injuring 28 others.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1975 — The start of the Wave Hill walk-off by Gurindji people in Australia, lasting eight years, a landmark event in the history of Indigenous land rights in Australia, commemorated in a 1991 Paul Kelly song and an annual celebration.
- 2010 — The Manila hostage crisis occurred near the Quirino Grandstand in Manila, Philippines killing 9 people including the perpetrator while injuring 9 others.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2007 — The skeletal remains of Russia's last royal family members Alexei Nikolaevich, Tsarevich of Russia, and his sister Grand Duchess Anastasia are discovered near Yekaterinburg, Russia.
- 2023 — Chandrayaan-3 mission initiated first Moon landing in Indian history.

- 1985 — Hans Tiedge, top counter-spy of West Germany, defects to East Germany.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 236 of the year, 129 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aurea of Ostia; Christian feast day: Bartholomew the Apostle (Roman Catholic, Anglican); Christian feast day: Edward Klinik; Christian feast day: Emily de Vialar. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1965 — Marlee Matlin, American actress and producer
- 1940 — Madsen Pirie, British academic, President and co-founder of the Adam Smith Institute
- 1949 — Stephen Paulus, American composer and educator (died 2014)
- 1955 — Kevin Dunn, American actor
- 1973 — Carmine Giovinazzo, American actor
- 1945 — Ken Hensley, English rock singer-songwriter and musician (died 2020)
- 1945 — Ronee Blakley, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1947 — Anne Archer, American actress and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2020 — Erin O'Toole is elected leader of the Conservative Party of Canada.
- 2004 — Ninety passengers die after two airliners explode after flying out of Domodedovo International Airport, near Moscow. The explosions are caused by suicide bombers from Chechnya.
- 2006 — The International Astronomical Union (IAU) redefines the term "planet" such that Pluto is now considered a dwarf planet.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1991 — Ukraine declares itself independent from the Soviet Union.
- 2010 — In San Fernando, Tamaulipas, Mexico, 72 illegal immigrants are killed by Los Zetas and eventually found dead by Mexican authorities.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)